Qiheng Lin

林琦桁

linqiheng6930@ruc.edu.cn

Research Interests and Methods

Human–AI relations, digital intimacy, influencer industries, and gendered labor.

Methods include ethnographic fieldwork, in-depth interviews, and social network analysis (UCINET and ENA).

Education

Renmin University of China Sep 2025–present

Ph.D. in Journalism and Communication, expected June 2029.

Renmin University of China Sep 2023–Jun 2025

Master of Journalism and Communication. GPA: 3.93/4.00; ranked 1st overall in the program.

Wuhan University Sep 2019–Jun 2023

Bachelor's degree in Radio and Television. GPA: 3.88/4.00; ranked 1st in the program for four consecutive years.

Journal Articles

Lin, Q., & Dong, C. (2026). The managed sisterhood: Gendered labor and intimacy in Chinese fashion influencer industry. *New Media & Society*. OnlineFirst, October 22, 2026. https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448261493399

Chinese-language journal articles

Lin, Q., & Peng, L. (2026). From viewing to co-presence: The turn toward companionship in online audiovisual media and its challenges. *China Television* [中国电视] (CSSCI), (3), 14–22.

Dong, C., **Lin, Q.**, & Liu, L. (2026). Wanghong: Understanding a local Chinese concept. *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (6), 5–15.

Ding, Y., Dong, C., Lü, X., **Lin, Q.**, Chen, Z., & Xu, Y. (2026). An annual review of Western communication research in 2025. *Journalism Review* [新闻记者] (CSSCI), (1), 50–71.

Dong, C., **Lin, Q.**, & Liu, L. (2025). When technology meets love: Algorithms, interfaces, and the rise of unconventional intimacy. *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (11), 5–13.

Dong, C., & **Lin, Q.** (2024). "Adhesive" and "metronome": Thematic evolution of online public opinion through a multidimensional social network analysis of the Li Jiaqi controversy. *Media Observer* [传媒观察] (CSSCI), (6), 24–34.

Dong, C., Xu, Y., & **Lin, Q.** (2024). Social interaction on platforms: Three strands of research on interpersonal communication on social media. *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (9), 5–14. Reprinted in full in Xinhua Digest.

Dong, C., Xu, Y., Ding, Y., Yu, W., **Lin, Q.**, Chen, Q., & Wang, H. (2024). An annual review of Western communication research in 2023. *Journalism Review* [新闻记者] (CSSCI), (1), 81–101, 41.

Lin, Q. (2022). Innovating empathic communication in mainstream media short videos: A case study of Xiaoyang Video. *View on Publishing* [出版广角] (CSSCI Expanded), (6), 93–96.

Ji, L., & **Lin, Q.** (2022). Communication strategies for mainstream media short videos from a technology empowerment perspective. *China Radio* [中国广播], (3), 9–14.

Book Reviews and Yearbook Contributions

Dong, C., Liu, L., & **Lin, Q.** (2025). From content creators to entrepreneurs: What does "wanghong" really mean? A review of The Influencer Factory. [从内容生产者到企业家："网红"究竟意味着什么?——评《网红工厂：一种YouTube企业化人格的马克思主义理论》] *China Book Review* [中国图书评论], (12), 20–29.

Lin, Q., & Dong, C. (2025). A review of research on Chinese influencers and livestreamers, 2023–2024. [中国网红主播研究2023—2024综述] *Yearbook of Journalism and Communication of China* [中国新闻传播学年鉴], Editorial Office of Journalism & Communication [新闻与传播研究编辑部].

Translation Projects

The Craft of Research, 5th edition (2025–2026). Lead translator of the Chinese edition. Xinhua Publishing House. In proofreading; not yet published.

In the Meantime: Temporality and Cultural Politics (2024–2025). Sole translator of the complete initial Chinese manuscript. China Renmin University Press. In proofreading; not yet published.

Conference Presentations

Lin, Q. (Jun 2025). Digital Healing Arts: Imaginaries and Practice of "AI Resurrection" under Chinese Views on Life and Death. 75th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA). Oral presentation · Denver, USA.

Lin, Q. (Jul 2025). In the Name of "Sisters": Managed Sisterhoods as Gendered Labor in Chinese Fashion Influencer Industry. International Association for Media and Communication Research Conference (IAMCR). Oral presentation · Singapore.

Lin, Q., & Zhao, R. (Aug 2025). Curating the Real-time: Classification Labor in Chinese E-commerce Live-streaming. American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (ASA). Oral presentation · Chicago, USA.

Lin, Q. (Oct 2026). From an Object of Remembrance to a Relational Other: The Workings and Limits of AI Resurrection within a Media Ensemble of Life and Death. [从纪念对象到关系对象：生死媒介丛中AI复生的运作与边界] Communication and China | Fudan Forum (2026). Presentation · Fudan University, Shanghai, China.

Dong, C., & **Lin, Q.** (Nov 2024). Manufacturing authenticity: Influencers' authenticity labor and its precarity. [制造本真：网红的本真性劳动及其不稳定性] 17th Chinese Young Communication Scholars Forum. Oral presentation · Shanghai, China.

Lin, Q. (Apr 2024). Understanding wanghong: An academic framework for a popular concept. [理解"网红"：一个流行概念的学术框架] Fifth Qingmei Forum. Poster presentation · Guangzhou, China.

Work in Progress

Relational Continuity and Practices of Continuation After AI Companion Disruption.
Lin, Q., Zhang, Y., & Chen, W.
This study examines how people decide whether an AI companion still feels like the same partner after a disruption and how they respond.

Patching AI: Fluid Supplementation in Knowledge Work.
Lin, Q.
This study examines how knowledge workers fill gaps in generative AI's capabilities and how those efforts reshape their everyday routines.

Honors and Awards

2021 National Scholarship (Undergraduate)
2024 National Scholarship (Master's)
2026 Doctoral Academic Scholarship; Ranked 1st in the doctoral cohort
2026 Doctoral Special-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence; Ranked 1st in the doctoral cohort
2024 First-Class Academic Scholarship, Renmin University of China
2022 Yu Gang–Song Xiao Scholarship; Top 1%
2020–2022 First-Class Scholarship, Wuhan University
2020 Blue Moon Scholarship
2025 Beijing Outstanding Graduate
2023 Outstanding Graduate, Wuhan University
2023 Grand Prize, Beijing Graduate English Speech Contest
2023 Model Merit Student, Wuhan University; Top 1%
2024 Merit Student, Renmin University of China
2020–2023 Merit Student, Wuhan University; Awarded in each of four consecutive years
2025 Outstanding Youth League Member, Renmin University of China
2020–2022 Social Activities Award, Wuhan University

Other Academic Experience

Fudan University Graduate Summer School Aug 2024

New Media and Just Communication in the Global Information Society. Delivered the closing remarks as the sole master's student representative.

Undergraduate Research Project Lead 2022

A study of the communication effects of neo-frugality advertising among university students. University-level project; completed.

China–Russia Youth Leadership Summer Camp 5–14 Jul 2026

Student assistant, Renmin University of China, Beijing. Supported organization and coordination throughout the programme, including academic sessions, media visits, cultural exchange, and collaborative video production.

Industry Experience

2024 **ShowWorld** — E-commerce livestreaming coordination (internship).
2023 **ByteDance · TikTok cross-border business** — Advertising operations (internship).
2022 **ByteDance · Feishu PR & Marketing** — Social media operations (internship).
2022 **Xinhua News Agency · New Media Department** — Editor, Ask a Reporter (internship).
2021 **China Unicom · Wuhan** — New media design and operations (internship).
2021 **Tencent · Television drama** — Content operations (internship).